

“IT HAS BEEN THE POLICY OF THE HOUSE OF BIRLA… TO HARNESS THE UNDEVELOPED RESOURCES OF THE COUNTRY, PROMOTE KNOW-HOW, CREATE SKILLED LABOUR AND MANAGERIAL TALENT, SPREAD EDUCATION…”

Challenging an unequal world

GD Birla was born into a Marwari trading family in Pilani, Rajasthan. Although he had little formal education (and was inducted into the family business from the age of thirteen), he was a voracious reader who read widely on everything from philosophy to geography to science. This helped him better understand the world around him and enabled him to engage with people from a variety of social backgrounds. Hard-working and intelligent, Birla was undaunted by the colonial government’s biased policies. He managed to successfully break into the European-dominated jute industry in Bengal, and expanded the family’s business interests into several new areas.